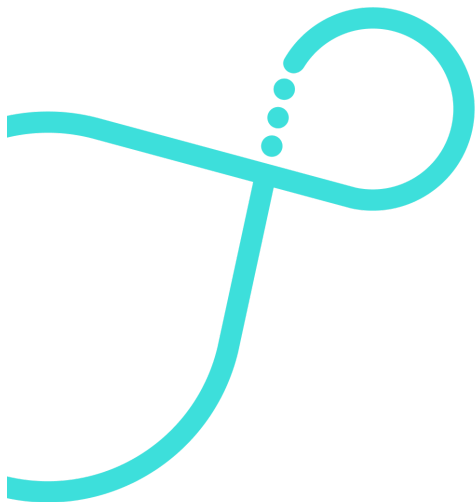




PEOPLE OPERATIONS · POLICY

Travel and Expenses

When external workers travel, how they get paid back, and what can and cannot be claimed.



Travel and Expenses

Revised March 2026

Audience

Hiring managers, HR and Finance

Classification

Internal use only

Rules for External Workers

External workers travel only where the work genuinely requires it, and it should be agreed before anything is booked.

The rule that catches people out: external workers do not get a Helvia credit card and do not book through our accounts. They pay for travel themselves, claim it back from their own employer, and their employer bills us. This applies to both tracks, and it applies to flights, hotels, car hire and rail alike.

The reason is not administrative. Putting an external worker on our corporate card and our travel account makes them look like our employee — it is one of the clearest co-employment signals there is.

Track 1 — contingent workers. Where travel is needed, agree it with the worker in advance and tell HR so the agency knows to expect the claim. The worker claims from the agency; the agency bills us at cost. Travel time during the working day is work time and is paid.

Track 2 — contractors. Travel is reimbursable only if the SOW says so. Agree the rules when you write the SOW: normally travel and accommodation at cost with receipts, and nothing else. A contractor who travels without it being in the SOW has no route to be paid for it.

Booking sensibly. We expect the same judgement we would apply to ourselves: book ahead rather than at the last minute, economy on flights, a reasonable hotel near the work. Nobody needs to find the absolute cheapest option, but nobody should be booking a flexible fare a day out without a reason.

International travel for a contingent worker is possible but tightly bounded: it must be initiated by us, agreed by the worker and the agency, and last no more than 10 business days. Anything longer raises tax and work-authorisation questions in the destination country. Talk to HR well in advance — this needs lead time.

Travelling is not the same as working abroad. A short business trip is fine. Doing the day job from another country is not. See Working From Outside the United States.

Safety. Anyone travelling on our business should have a way to reach us and we should know roughly where they are. For anything beyond routine domestic travel, tell HR the destination and dates.

What Can and Cannot Be Claimed

This is what we will reimburse when an external worker travels on our business — via their employer for contingent workers, or per the SOW for contractors.

	Reimbursable	Notes
Travel		
Flights, economy	Yes	Book ahead where possible
Rail, standard class	Yes	
Checked baggage	Yes	One bag

	Reimbursable	Notes
Seat upgrades, lounge access, airline memberships	No	
Car hire	Yes, where it is the sensible option	Mid-size or smaller
Fuel for a hire car	Yes	Return it full
Taxis, rideshare, public transport	Yes	
Mileage in their own car	Yes, at the standard IRS rate	Only where agreed in advance
Parking and tolls	Yes	
Commuting to their normal workplace	No	Including mileage and parking
Accommodation		
Hotel room and tax	Yes	Reasonable standard, near the work
Hotel on the night of an overnight flight	Yes	
Room service movies, minibar, spa, gym	No	
Late cancellation or no-show	Yes, if unavoidable	Cancel in time where you can
Meals		
Own meals while travelling overnight	Yes	Reasonable, with receipts
A meal with a customer or partner	Yes	Note who attended and why
Alcohol	Only with a meal, in moderation	
Meals on a normal working day at their usual location	No	
Other		
Laundry on trips over 7 days	Yes	
Tips, reasonable	Yes	
Wi-Fi and phone charges needed for work	Yes	
Visa and entry fees for required travel	Yes	
Travel insurance, medical costs, vaccinations	No	Their employer's responsibility
Family or partner travel	No	

	Reimbursable	Notes
Fines, penalties and parking tickets	No	
Personal items, toiletries, entertainment	No	

Receipts. Every line needs one. Claims arrive through the agency or on a contractor invoice, and Finance will query anything without support.

Timing. Claims should reach us within 30 days of the trip. Late claims still get paid but they make budget tracking painful.

If something is not on this list, ask before spending rather than after. finance@helvia.ai for whether it is claimable, hr@helvia.ai for whether it is appropriate.